

Sandeep Asolkar

Enabling Technology-Led Solutions for India's Water and Waste Future

While most entrepreneurs chase market demand, Sandeep Asolkar created it, transforming wastewater treatment from compliance burden into technological leadership that defined national standards.

India's development journey has reached a point where scale alone is no longer sufficient. As cities expand and industries grow, the resilience of foundational systems—particularly those governing water and waste—will increasingly determine the durability of economic progress.

For Sandeep Asolkar, Chairman and Managing Director of SFC Environmental Technologies, this insight has shaped more than three decades in environmental engineering. His conviction is clear: a developed nation is not defined only by what it builds, but by how intelligently it manages its resources.

IDENTIFYING THE GAP

In the early 2000s, wastewater treatment in India was largely viewed as a regulatory necessity. Systems were designed to comply, not to perform consistently or enable reuse. Asolkar believed the constraint was not the absence of plants, but the absence of robust, context-appropriate treatment technology.

This led to the founding of SFC Environmental Technologies in 2005, with a deliberate strategic choice: SFC would operate as a technology provider, supporting developers, municipalities, and operators—rather than as a construction contractor or asset owner. The objective was to strengthen sector capability through innovation, reliability, and long-term performance.

BUILDING THROUGH TECHNOLOGY

At the center of this approach was C-Tech, a Sequencing Batch Reactor (SBR)-based wastewater treatment technology adapted for Indian operating conditions. Designed for automation, compact footprint, and predictable outcomes, C-Tech addressed several limitations of conventional systems.

Beginning with its first installation in Goa, C-Tech has since been deployed across municipal and institutional projects nationwide. As of March 31, 2025, more than 639 installations have been commissioned. These systems support non-potable reuse applications such as industrial processes, gardening, and municipal utilities—helping shift wastewater treatment from disposal-centric models toward reuse-oriented outcomes.

FROM TREATMENT TO REUSE

In recent years, Asolkar's focus has increasingly moved toward water recycling and reuse as a strategic imperative. Under his leadership, SFC's portfolio has expanded to include submerged ultrafiltration (SUF), Membrane Bioreactors (MBR), and Closed-Circuit Reverse Osmosis (CCRO)—enabling higher-quality treated water suitable for industrial reuse.

"As the demand for sustainable water management grows, the mission is clear—to empower our customers with the most advanced and reliable wastewater reuse technologies," says Asolkar. "With a growing portfolio from SUF to CCRO, we aim to simplify this shift, reduce lifecycle costs, and support long-term environmental resilience."

APPLYING THE SAME DISCIPLINE TO SOLID WASTE

Asolkar has applied the same technology-first, ground-driven approach to municipal solid waste



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management. Through Hindustan Waste Treatment Private Limited, a 100% subsidiary of SFC Environmental Technologies, he spent over five years working closely at operating facilities in Goa—continuously refining processes to address India's mixed waste realities.

The resulting facilities integrate segregation, recycling, bio-methanation, and composting, reflecting solutions shaped by operational learning rather than static design.

A PRACTICAL VISION FOR SUSTAINABLE GROWTH

Across water and waste, Asolkar's work reflects a consistent philosophy: environmental infrastructure must enable growth, not constrain it. When systems are engineered to perform reliably, adapt to real-world conditions, and support reuse and recovery, sustainability becomes practical rather than aspirational.

As India advances toward its next phase of development, such technology-led, execution-grounded approaches will quietly determine how resilient that growth truly is.